



Software Factories

From vibe coding to a machine that ships
while you sleep

Patrick Robinson · On PAR Dev

Sep 8, 2026 · San Antonio

WELCOME

Where Texas builds agent systems

THE DEAL

Demos, not pitches

CADENCE

Monthly, every month

OCTOBER

Agents that live with you

Hosted by Alamo Tech Collective at Zelifcam.



WHO I AM

Patrick Robinson

DAY JOB

Consultant at Lean TECHniques — coaching teams on AI, developers and everyone else

OWN SHOP

On PAR Dev — my agency, building agentic systems and software for small and mid-size businesses

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AGENDA

Tonight, in seven beats

01 All the engineering

02 What a software factory is

03 My journey to a daemon

04 Anatomy of the factory

05 Live demo

06 What broke

07 The takeaway

FEB 2025 → TODAY

The naming treadmill

Vibes Prompt Context Agentic Loop Graph Harness All the
engineering

Each rename moves the human one step further from the keystroke — and one step closer to designing the system that types.

“FACTORY” IS A DIRTY WORD

“Just sitting in the factory, cranking out features, sending them down the line.”

Me, seven years and two jobs ago

The metaphor stuck thanks to John Cutler, 2016

OLDER THAN THE INSULT

Three eras of “software factory”

1969

Hitachi Software Works

Standardize people,
process, and reuse.

2004

Greenfield & Short,
Microsoft

Purpose-built mini-
languages and templates
assemble apps from a
product line.

2026

Us, in this room

Agents plan, build, verify,
and ship. Humans set intent
and guardrails.

THE DEFINITION

A repeatable, observable pipeline that turns an *intent* into verified, reviewed, mergeable, working software.

Not a feature factory: it measures itself, and the human still owns the why.

JOURNEY · JANUARY 2026

Attempt one: ai-sdlc

REFINE

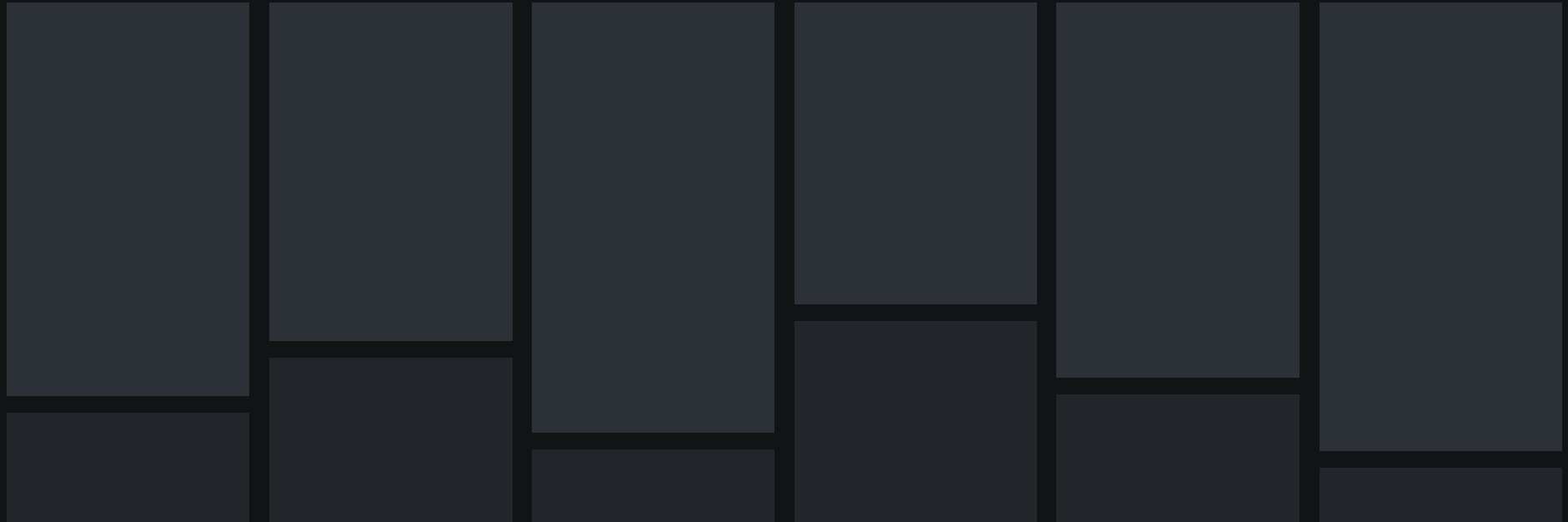
RESEARCH

PLAN

IMPLEMENT

REVIEW

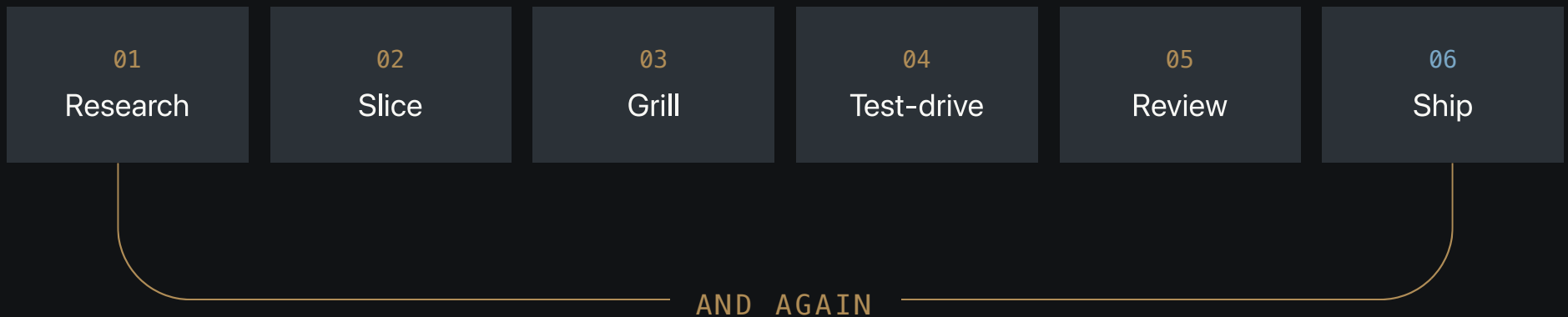
PR



Right shape. Wrong order. ~300 commits · paused June

JOURNEY · SPRING TO SUMMER

I was the loop



Same six skills, same order, every change. The human was the scheduler.

JOURNEY · JULY 7

668

lines of bash

Great for three days. Then reality.

WHAT BROKE IT

Parallel work in git worktrees

Resuming paused and failed runs

Usage caps, and a second machine

JOURNEY • JULY 10 → TODAY

The factory builds the factory

545

COMMITTS

742

ISSUES

561

PULL REQUESTS

85

ADRs, SELF-
WRITTEN

software-factory

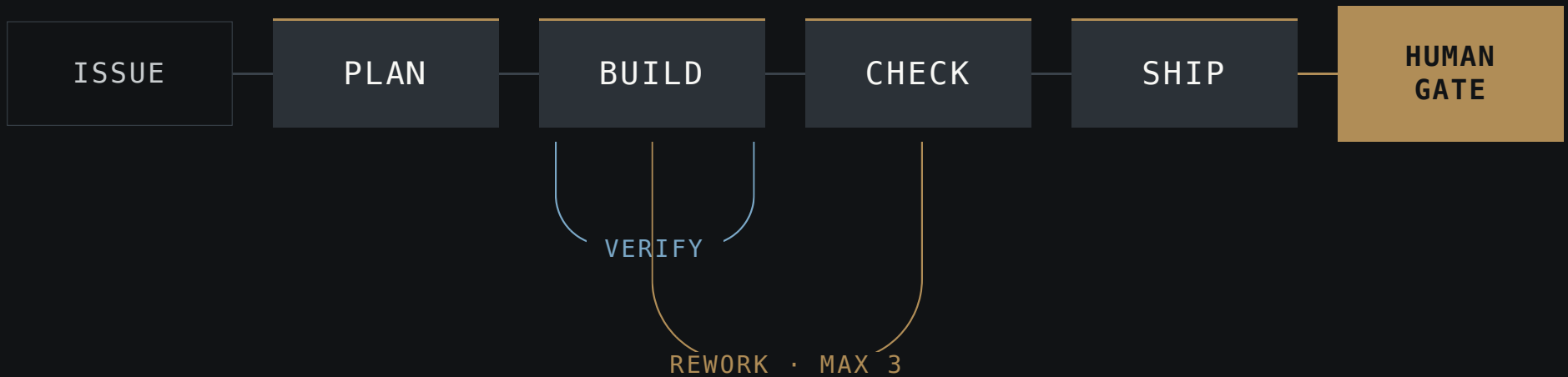
The engine. TypeScript monorepo, one daemon per machine.

control plane

The control surface. Started Aug 28 — built mostly by the engine.

ANATOMY · THE ENGINE

Plan, build, check, ship



QUEUE

GitHub labels are the queue

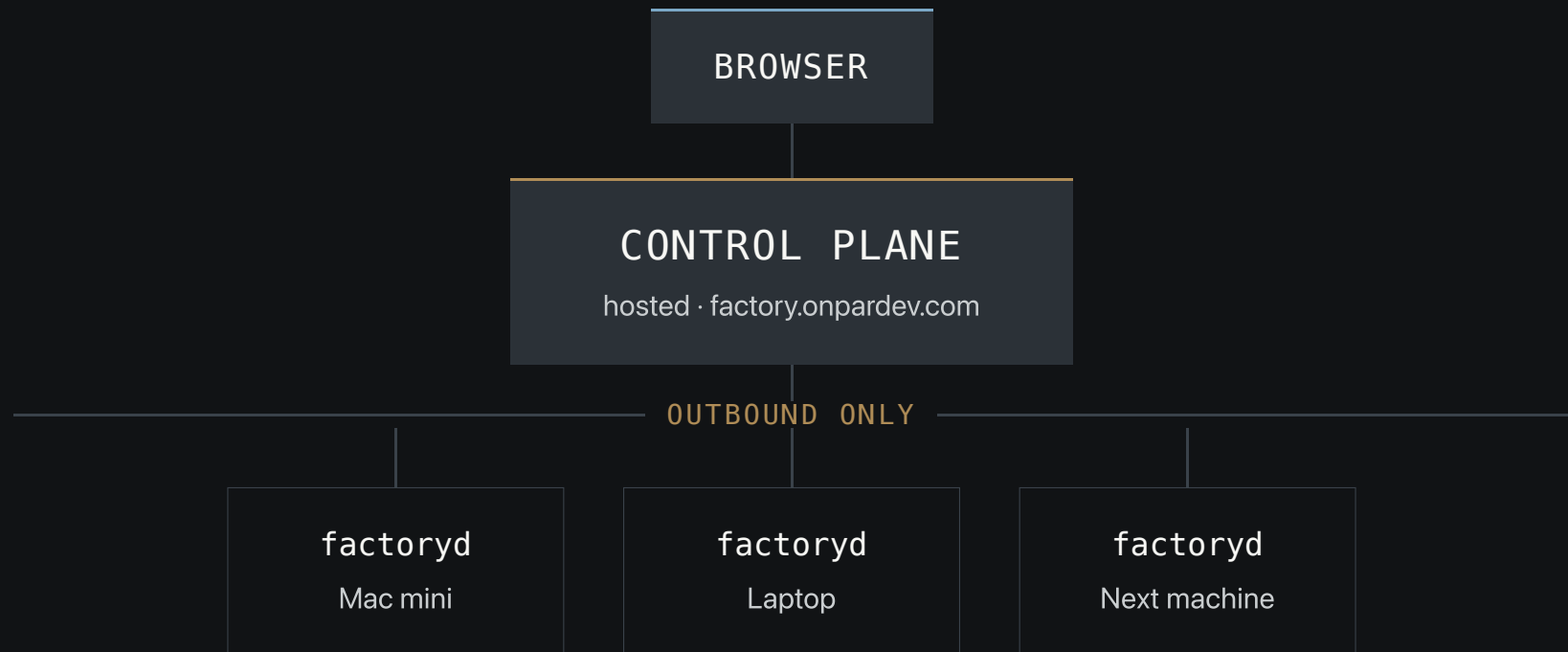
RULES

A constitution per product

STUCK

Same failure twice escalates to me

One plane, many machines



Credentials never leave the machine. Enrollment is a one-time code.

SOUND BUDDY · JULY 7 → TODAY

The numbers

672

MERGED PRs

74%

MERGE RATE

73%

FULLY AUTONOMOUS

27 min

MEDIAN CYCLE TIME

\$0.12

MEDIAN COST / PR

1.2%

HUMAN INTERVENTION

My app, my constitution — your mileage will vary. The point is that it can be measured at all.

LIVE DEMO

Sound Buddy, start to gate

Pick a node, a repo, an issue

Start the run, close the browser

Come back to a PR at the gate

The screenshot displays the 'On PAR Factory' dashboard. The left sidebar contains the 'OPT' logo and navigation links for 'Overview', 'Work board', and 'Settings'. The main content area is titled 'ON PAR / LOCAL WORKSPACE' and 'Your delivery team'. It features a status summary with four categories: 'IN FLIGHT' (0), 'NEEDS A LOOK' (5), 'SUCCEEDED' (1), and 'COMPUTERS' (1/1). Below this, the 'Your computers' section shows 'Patricks-Mini' as the only connected device. The 'Start a delivery' section provides a form to select a computer, repository, issue, and model routing, with a 'Start run' button. The 'Runs' section lists several runs with their status (CANCELED, SUCCEEDED, FAILED) and timestamps. A 'Connected to control plane' indicator is visible in the top right corner.

Local workspace

ON PAR / LOCAL WORKSPACE

Connected to control plane

Your delivery team

Start with a GitHub issue. Choose the computer that does the work. Come back from any connected device.

IN FLIGHT	NEEDS A LOOK	SUCCEEDED	COMPUTERS
0	5	1	1/1
Nothing running now	Open the run to see what stopped it.	1 with a pull request.	All connected

Your computers

1 connected Add a computer

Patricks-Mini

Online - 2 repositories

Last seen: 9/8/2026, 2:46:31 PM

Remove

Start a delivery

One issue, one computer, a traceable result.

COMPUTER

Patricks-Mini

REPOSITORY

on-par/sound-buddy

ISSUE

#1395 Fix Fit sel to zoom to the drawn time s...

MODEL ROUTING

Auto (best available)

Default from Settings. You can override per run.

Start run

Work runs on the selected computer and continues when you leave this page.

Runs

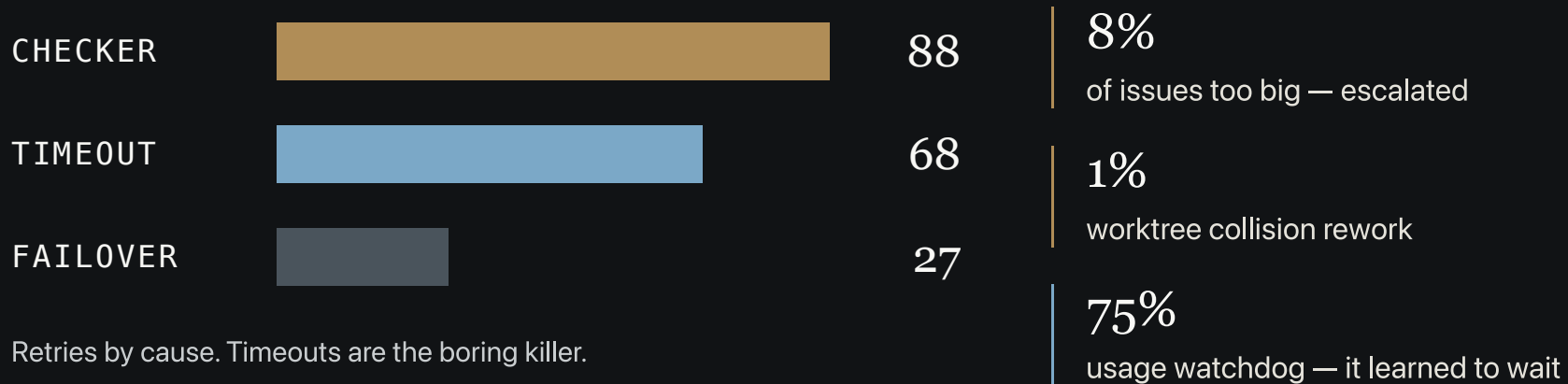
8 total

on-par/sound-buddy #1395	CANCELED
Patricks-Mini: 9/8/2026, 2:27:24 PM	
Canceled by operator; inspect worktree and PR state before retrying.	
on-par/sound-buddy #1395	CANCELED
Patricks-Mini: 9/8/2026, 1:13:04 PM	
Canceled by operator; inspect worktree and PR state before retrying.	
on-par/sound-buddy #1391	SUCCEEDED
Patricks-Mini: 9/7/2026, 9:52:45 PM	
Pull request ready for review; check CI before merging.	
on-par/sound-buddy #41	FAILED
Patricks-Mini: 9/7/2026, 9:35:45 PM	
factory ship ended without a verified pull request (exit 0).	

Select a run to see its outcome and execution log.

THE HONEST SLIDE

What broke, by cause



WHAT I LEARNED

Six rules I'd hand a beginner

- 01 Do the loop by hand until it's boring
- 02 The verify loop is the product
- 03 Write the constitution first
- 04 Measure it, or it's a feature factory
- 05 Humans belong at the gates*
- 06 Script prototypes, engineering ships

* There's work that probably needs no human in the loop at all, but that's a different talk.

THE TAKEAWAY

You already have a factory. It's you,
running the same steps in the same
order.

Write it down. Make it verify itself. Stand at the gates.



NEXT MONTH

Agents that live with you

OpenClaw, Hermes, and Grok Bot — October, same room.

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 on-par/software-factory



SLIDES & SOURCES

Thanks to Alamo Tech Collective, Zelifcam, and everyone who showed up for Night One.